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Method of Digital Labeling Control System Terminals That Enables Guided Wiring

Abstract

Tools and techniques are described to create a controller wiring board. A user, using a user interface associated with a controller, can determine which devices will be attached to a controller. The features of the devices may be already known by the controller. The controller can change wiring terminal types depending on the requirements of the devices wired to the controllers. In some embodiments, a device is wired to a module associated with the controller. The controller can signal to the module to modify its wiring terminal to match the needs of the device to be wired to that location.

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Background/Summary

RELATED APPLICATION [0001] The present application hereby incorporates by reference the entirety of, and claims priority to, U.S. Utility patent application Ser. No. 17/842,308, filed Jun. 16, 2022, which incorporates by reference the entirety of, and claims priority to U.S. Utility patent application Ser. No. 17/135,591, now U.S. Pat. No. 11,477,905, filed Dec. 28, 2020, which incorporates by reference the entirety of, and claims priority to U.S. Provisional Patent Application Ser. No. 63/070,460 filed 26 Aug. 2020.

FIELD

[0002] The present disclosure relates to a digital labeling control system that enables guided wiring. More specifically, to controllers using a swarm of self-healing nodes to control resources.

BACKGROUND

[0003] Controlling buildings is a huge problem because the amount of computing power is so big. To develop a building plan and a wiring diagram currently requires IT networking skills, programming skills, and engineering skills. Specifically, programming sequences need to be determined manually, manual equipment discovery and wire-up must be separately (and manually) done using BACNET, DIRECT, etc.

SUMMARY

[0004] This summary is provided to introduce a selection of concepts in a simplified form that are further described below in the Detailed Description section. This summary does not identify required or essential features of the claimed subject matter.

[0005] In general, one innovative embodiment comprises a method to create a wiring panel for a controller. The controller comprises, at least, a processor, memory, and wiring terminals. A plurality of point locations are presented on a display associated with the controller. The point locations represent wiring terminals that can be used to wire devices to the controller. A plurality of device types are listed on the controller, the device types representing devices able to be wired to the controller. The device types have a protocol and a device point type. The user can move a device type to a controller point location. The controller can modify its wiring terminal to match the type of wiring terminal that the device requires.

[0006] In some embodiments, the controller has modules that connect to the controller. The modules have wiring terminals that are able to connect a device wire to the controller through a module connection. Some modules may have a module circuit board, which can accept a signal from the controller, the signal telling the module to modify a terminal such that it matches the requirements for a device that is to be wired to that location.

[0007] In some embodiments, a user can use an interface associated with the controller to determine which devices go where on the controller.

[0008] The examples given are merely illustrative. This Summary is not intended to identify key features or essential features of the claimed subject matter, nor is it intended to be used to limit the scope of the claimed subject matter. Rather, this Summary is provided to introduce—in a simplified form—some technical concepts that are further described below in the Detailed Description. The innovation is defined with claims, and to the extent this Summary conflicts with the claims, the claims should prevail.

[0009] Additional features and advantages will become apparent from the following detailed description of illustrated embodiments, which proceeds with reference to accompanying drawings.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE FIGURES

[0010] Non-limiting and non-exhaustive embodiments of the present embodiments are described with reference to the following FIGURES, wherein like reference numerals refer to like parts throughout the various views unless otherwise specified.

[0011] FIG. 1 is a functional block diagram showing an exemplary embodiment of a digital label control system in conjunction which described embodiments can be implemented.

[0012] FIG. 2 is a flow chart showing an exemplary embodiment of creating a control system with which described embodiments can be implemented.

[0013] FIG. 3 is a diagram representing a relationship between a controller and a physical structure in conjunction which described embodiments can be implemented.

[0014] FIG. 4 is a block diagram describing embodiments of device types in conjunction with which described embodiments can be implemented.

[0015] FIG. 5 is a diagram representing a relationship between point locations and wiring terminals in conjunction with which described embodiments can be implemented.

[0016] FIG. 6 is a flow chart showing an exemplary embodiment of screen actions in conjunction with which described embodiments can be implemented.

[0017] FIG. 7 is an exemplary screen shot in conjunction with which described embodiments can be implemented.

[0018] FIG. 8 is a block diagram showing an exemplary relationship between controllers, modules, and devices, in conjunction with which described embodiments can be implemented.

[0019] FIGS. 9-17 are exemplary screen shots in conjunction with which described embodiments can be implemented.

[0020] FIG. 18 is a drawing of a portion of a controller showing a module in conjunction with

which described embodiments can be implemented

[0021] FIG. **19** is a drawing of a module in conjunction with which described embodiments can be implemented.

[0022] FIG. **20** is a diagram of a module circuit board with which described embodiments can be implemented.

[0023] Corresponding reference characters indicate corresponding components throughout the several views of the drawings. Skilled artisans will appreciate that elements in the FIGURES are illustrated for simplicity and clarity and have not necessarily been drawn to scale. For example, the dimensions of some of the elements in the figures may be exaggerated relative to other elements to help to improve understanding of various embodiments. Also, common but well-understood elements that are useful or necessary in a commercially feasible embodiment are often not depicted in order to facilitate a less obstructed view of these various embodiments.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0024] Disclosed below are representative embodiments of methods, computer-readable media, and systems having particular applicability to controllers using digital labeling to enable guided wiring. In the following description, numerous specific details are set forth in order to provide a thorough understanding of the present embodiments. It will be apparent, however, to one having ordinary skill in the art that the specific detail need not be employed to practice the present embodiments. In other instances, well-known materials or methods have not been described in detail in order to avoid obscuring the present embodiments. “one embodiment”, “an embodiment”, “one example” or “an example” means that a particular feature, structure or characteristic described in connection with the embodiment or example is included in at least one embodiment of the present embodiments. Thus, appearances of the phrases “in one embodiment”, “in an embodiment”, “one example” or “an example” in various places throughout this specification are not necessarily all referring to the same embodiment or example. Modifications, additions, or omissions may be made to the systems, apparatuses, and methods described herein without departing from the scope of the disclosure. For example, the components of the systems and apparatuses may be integrated or separated. Moreover, the operations of the systems and apparatuses disclosed herein may be performed by more, fewer, or other components and the methods described may include more, fewer, or other steps. Additionally, steps may be performed in any suitable order.

[0025] In addition, it is appreciated that the figures provided herewith are for explanation purposes to persons ordinarily skilled in the art and that the drawings are not necessarily drawn to scale. To aid the Patent Office and any readers of any patent issued on this application in interpreting the claims appended hereto, applicants wish to note that they do not intend any of the appended claims or claim elements to invoke 35 U.S.C. 112(f) unless the words “means for” or “step for” are explicitly used in the particular claim.

[0026] Embodiments in accordance with the present embodiments may be implemented as an apparatus, method, or computer program product. Accordingly, the present embodiments may take the form of an entirely hardware embodiment, an entirely software embodiment (including firmware, resident software, micro-code, etc.), or an embodiment combining software and hardware aspects that may all generally be referred to herein as a “module” or “system.” Furthermore, the present embodiments may take the form of a computer program product embodied in any tangible medium of expression having computer-usable program code embodied in the medium.

[0027] Any combination of one or more computer-usable or computer-readable media may be utilized. For example, a computer-readable medium may include one or more of a portable computer diskette, a hard disk, a random access memory (RAM) device, a read-only memory (ROM) device, an erasable programmable read-only memory (EPROM or Flash memory) device, a portable compact disc read-only memory (CDROM), an optical storage device, and a magnetic storage device. Computer program code for carrying out operations of the present embodiments

may be written in any combination of one or more programming languages.

[0028] The flowchart and block diagrams in the flow diagrams illustrate the architecture, functionality, and operation of possible implementations of systems, methods, and computer program products according to various embodiments of the present embodiments. In this regard, each block in the flowchart or block diagrams may represent a module, segment, or portion of code, which comprises one or more executable instructions for implementing the specified logical function(s). It will also be noted that each block of the block diagrams and/or flowchart illustrations, and combinations of blocks in the block diagrams and/or flowchart illustrations, may be implemented by special purpose hardware-based systems that perform the specified functions or acts, or combinations of special purpose hardware and computer instructions. These computer program instructions may also be stored in a computer-readable medium that can direct a computer or other programmable data processing apparatus to function in a particular manner, such that the instructions stored in the computer-readable medium produce an article of manufacture including instruction means which implement the function/act specified in the flowchart and/or block diagram block or blocks.

[0029] As used herein, the terms “comprises,” “comprising,” “includes,” “including,” “has,” “having,” or any other variation thereof, are intended to cover a non-exclusive inclusion. For example, a process, article, or apparatus that comprises a list of elements is not necessarily limited to only those elements but may include other elements not expressly listed or inherent to such process, article, or apparatus.

[0030] Further, unless expressly stated to the contrary, “or” refers to an inclusive or and not to an exclusive or. For example, a condition A or B is satisfied by any one of the following: A is true (or present) and B is false (or not present), A is false (or not present) and B is true (or present), and both A and B are true (or present). “Program” is used broadly herein, to include applications, kernels, drivers, interrupt handlers, firmware, state machines, libraries, and other code written by programmers (who are also referred to as developers) and/or automatically generated. “Optimize” means to improve, not necessarily to perfect. For example, it may be possible to make further improvements in a program or an algorithm which has been optimized.

[0031] “Automatically” means by use of automation (e.g., general purpose computing hardware configured by software for specific operations and technical effects discussed herein), as opposed to without automation. In particular, steps performed “automatically” are not performed by hand on paper or in a person's mind, although they may be initiated by a human person or guided interactively by a human person. Automatic steps are performed with a machine in order to obtain one or more technical effects that would not be realized without the technical interactions thus provided.

[0032] Additionally, any examples or illustrations given herein are not to be regarded in any way as restrictions on, limits to, or express definitions of any term or terms with which they are utilized. Instead, these examples or illustrations are to be regarded as being described with respect to one particular embodiment and as being illustrative only. Those of ordinary skill in the art will appreciate that any term or terms with which these examples or illustrations are utilized will encompass other embodiments which may or may not be given therewith or elsewhere in the specification and all such embodiments are intended to be included within the scope of that term or terms. Language designating such nonlimiting examples and illustrations includes, but is not limited to: “for example,” “for instance,” “e.g.,” and “in one embodiment.”

[0033] Various alternatives to the implementations described herein are possible. For example, embodiments described with reference to flowchart diagrams can be altered, such as, for example, by changing the ordering of stages shown in the flowcharts, or by repeating or omitting certain stages.

I. Overview

[0034] With reference to FIG. 1, aspects of the present disclosure pertain to digital labeling control

system that enables guided wiring. This system may be used with any of the embodiments described herein. Specifically, controller **100** includes at least one central processing unit **105** and memory **115, 125**. The processing unit executes computer-executable instructions and may be a real or a virtual processor. There might also be a vector or co/processing unit **110** that enables fast vector processing. In a multi-processing system, multiple processing units execute computer-executable instructions to increase processing power. The controller may further comprise multiple controllers in communication using wired or wireless connections. These controllers may use a distributed operating system to communicate and divide tasks.

[0035] The memory **115, 125** may be volatile memory (e.g., registers, cache, RAM), non-volatile memory (e.g., ROM, EEPROM, flash memory, etc.), or some combination of the two. For example, the memory can be volatile memory, e.g., static memory cells, as in FPGAs and some CPLDs; or non-volatile memory, e.g., FLASH memory, as in some CPLDs, or in any other appropriate type of memory cell. The memory stores software implementing described techniques and tools. The computer system may be distributed, with multiple processors and associated memory in different locations that communicate using wired or wireless network connections. These distributed computing nodes may run simultaneously run the same program using distributed computing techniques.

[0036] A controller computing environment may have additional features. For example, the computing environment may include storage **120** which may also include memory **125**, one or more input devices **130**, one or more output devices **135**, and one or more other communication devices **140**. These may include touch screens, keyboards, game controllers, touchpads, LED screens, voice-operated input systems, printers, phone connections, FAX machines, etc. An interconnection mechanism such as a bus, controller, or network interconnects the components of the computing environment.

[0037] Typically, operating system software stored in memory **115, 125** provides an operating environment for other software executing in the computing environment, and coordinates activities of the components of the computing environment. The controller computer system **100** can connect to other computer systems through network(s) **150**, which may be wired, wireless, or both. Peripherals **155**, such as external hard drives, modems, mice, keyboards, zip drives, scanners, 3-d printers, etc. The controller **100** also comprises a display apparatus **180**. The display apparatus **180** can be any display that is capable of displaying information in pictorial form. It may be able to accept input from the controller or from another source and display that input on a screen. It may also be capable of accepting input from the screen and passing that information to the controller. Users **145** may interact with the controller **100** through networks **150**, the display apparatus **180**, communications devices **140**, etc.

[0038] The computing system **100**, like other suitable systems, also includes one or more computer-readable storage media **160**. Media **160** may be of different physical types. The media **160** may be volatile memory, non-volatile memory, fixed in place media, removable media, magnetic media, optical media, solid-state media, and/or of other types of physical durable storage media (as opposed to merely a propagated signal). In particular, a configured medium **160** such as a portable (i.e., external) hard drive, CD, DVD, memory stick, or other removable non-volatile, non-transient memory medium may become functionally a technological part of the computer system when inserted or otherwise installed, making its content accessible for interaction with and use by central processing unit **105**. The removable configured medium **960** is an example of a computer-readable storage medium **160**. Some other examples of computer-readable storage media **160** include built-in RAM, ROM, hard disks, and other memory storage devices which are not readily removable by users **945**. A computer-readable medium should not be considered a signal; neither should a computer-readable memory be considered a signal.

[0039] The medium **160** is configured with instructions **170** that are executable by a central processing unit **105**; “executable” is used broadly to include, human readable source code, such as

Java or C++, compiled code, and/or machine code. Executable code also includes code that runs using a distributed system, such as a series of controllers and controllers that distribute and run complex problems. The medium **160** is also configured with data **165** which is created, modified, referenced, and/or otherwise used for technical effect by execution of the instructions **170**. The instructions **170** and the data **165** configure the memory or other storage medium **160** in which they reside; when that memory or other computer readable storage medium is a functional part of a given computer system, the computer system may be configured by the instructions **170** and data **165**.

[0040] The controller may compromise one or more wiring terminals **175**. These wiring terminals **175** are used to wire a device to the controller **100**. Such devices comprise HVAC equipment, lighting equipment, irrigation equipment, sensors, security equipment, and so forth. Some devices require multiple wiring terminals. Messages may then be sent from the controller to the device through the wiring terminal. Messages may also be sent from the device to the controller through the wiring terminal. In some embodiments a module attached to the controller. In these embodiments, the wiring terminals attach to the module. The wiring terminals attach to the controller through the module. The wiring terminal **175** may be directly attached to the controller **105**, or may be part of a module that is itself attached to the controller, receives signals from the controller, and passes signals to the controller. One or more wiring terminals comprise a wiring panel, which may be comprised of modules.

[0041] Although an embodiment may be described as being implemented as software instructions executed by one or more processors in a computing device (e.g., general purpose computer, cell phone, or controller), such description is not meant to exhaust all possible embodiments. One of skill will understand that the same or similar functionality can also often be implemented, in whole or in part, directly in hardware logic, to provide the same or similar technical effects. Alternatively, or in addition to software implementation, the technical functionality described herein can be performed, at least in part, by one or more hardware logic components. For example, and without excluding other implementations, an embodiment may include hardware logic components such as Field-Programmable Gate Arrays (FPGAs), Application-Specific Integrated Circuits (ASICs), Application-Specific Standard Products (ASSPs), System-on-a-Chip components (SOCs), Complex Programmable Logic Devices (CPLDs), and similar components. Components of an embodiment may be grouped into interacting functional modules based on their inputs, outputs, and/or their technical effects, for example.

II. Exemplary Method and Systems for Creating a Controller Wiring Board

[0042] With reference to FIGS. **2** and **3**, a method for creating a controller wiring board is disclosed. The controller wiring board comprises the controller and its wiring terminals knowing what devices are to be wired to it, and the wiring terminals of the correct type to be wired to the devices. The controller **310** is operationally able to accept representation of a physical structure **205**, which may be a blueprint, and/or may be in the format in a computer-readable format **305** (e.g., GBXML, IFC, ResCheck, ComCheck, etc.), may be a room scan (or series of scans of spaces) created using scanning hardware and/or software; the representation of the physical structure may be input using the I/O device **315**. The wiring terminal **175** may be directly attached to the controller **105**, or may be part of a module that is itself attached to the controller, receives signals from the controller, and passes signals to the controller. One or more wiring terminals comprise a wiring panel, which may be comprised of modules. The wiring terminal itself is able to be wired to a device that will be controlled by the controller. Such devices comprise HVAC equipment, lighting equipment, irrigation equipment, sensors, security equipment, and so forth. Some devices require multiple wiring terminals.

[0043] At **210**, the controller **100** is operationally able to accept a predefined unit model from a list of predefined unit models displayed on the display apparatus **180**. With reference to FIG. **7**, a graphical representation of at least a portion of a control system is shown. At **700** an embodiment is

disclosed that allows a user to chose a predefined unit model **710** from a list of predefined unit modules **710** using a WYSIWYG interface. Specifically, a user selects a type of unit model, such as a sensor, a user input, or an indicator, a heat source, a solar source, a pump, and so on. Once a unit model has been chosen, a user can use a cursor, a mouse, their finger, etc. to place the unit model within a representation of the physical structure.

[0044] In some embodiments, the following basic graphic concepts are used.

[0045] LEFT DRAWERS: Far left drawers **710** provide general categories of unit models. When a drawer is opened, specific unit models that can be chosen are exposed. The illustrative example shows Mechanical devices.

[0046] MAIN GRAPH PANELS: The graph panel **720** provides an overall drawing of a controller that is being worked on.

[0047] In an illustrative embodiment, once a user has placed the representation of the unit model within the representation of the physical structure, the controller is operationally able to accept the placement location of the predefined unit model type **215**, at the location chosen. In some implementations, the physical model may be divided, with just a portion displayed at a time. Possible divisions are: Floor **1**, Floor **2**, Floor **3**, Outdoor, etc. Once a division is chosen, further subdivisions may be chosen. Such subdivisions may comprise entry, dining, sitting, kitchen, living, exercise, air studio, bath. The specific divisions and subdivisions may depend on the physical structure and how it has been represented within the controller.

[0048] At **220**, the controller is operationally able to create a control system for the physical structure, the predefined unit model, and the controller model, with the predefined unit model represented as being wired to the controller. A control system is a system whose output can be managed (controlled or regulated) by modifying its input. This information includes inputs and outputs. This information may also include the specific wiring information needed to wire the unit models.

[0049] With reference to FIG. **4**, a system that can be used in embodiments disclosed herein is shown. A device type **405** comprises a protocol **410**, and a device point type **425**. "Protocol" may be understood as a broad term encompassing open protocols such as BACnet, closed protocols, such as SNA, protocols for individual pieces of equipment, such as whether they are analog, the voltage allowances, e.g., 0-10 volts, a single value such as 40 milliamps or 12 volts; the signals that a specific piece of equipment uses to communicate with a controller, such as on/off values, current, voltage, networkable protocol, modulation, frequency, any combination of the above, etc. A device point type is the specific type of the signals that will transfer down the wire that will be wired to the terminal, such as (+), (-), (~), (1 w), (O), (C), (A), (B), and others, as known by those of skill in the art.

[0050] With reference to FIG. **5** and FIG. **6**, a controller **510** has wiring terminals **515**, **520**, representations of which are shown as point locations **505**, **525** on a display apparatus **500**. At **605**, a plurality of point locations are presented, the point locations representing wiring terminals. An example of point locations representing wiring terminals is shown at FIG. **5**.

[0051] At **605**, a plurality of point locations (e.g. **505**, **525**) are presented on a display (e.g. **500**). At **610**, a plurality of device types **405** are presented on the display; these device types associated with the controller **100**, a plurality of device types representing devices able to be wired to the controller; the device type having a protocol and a device point type, as described with reference to FIG. **4**. At **615**, the controller responds to a user's selection of a device type and a point location. At **620**, a wiring terminal (e.g., **215**) represented by a point location (e.g., **505**) is modified to match the device point type (e.g., **425**). The wiring terminal may be modified using software stored in the memory **115**, **125** of the controller **100** and run using the processor **105**, **110**.

[0052] With reference to FIG. **7**, at an exemplary screenshot is shown illustrating methods and systems described herein. At **705**, a point location is shown that represents a wiring terminal on a controller. At **710**, a plurality of device types are presented on the display, the device type

representing devices able to be wired to the controller, in this case, two Three Way Valves. In some implementations, a user specifies beforehand what devices are in a space that will be controlled by the controller. Those devices that are not yet assigned a controller location then show up on the interface to be moved into position. In some implementations, a library of possible devices is listed on the interface. In some implementations, a user is able to specify devices and their characteristics to be added to a controller. In some implementations, a wide range of devices are preloaded into the controller. A user can select a device type **710**, and then move that device type to a wiring terminal (or terminals) e.g., **705**. In response to a user's selection of a device type **710** and a point location **705**, a controller can then modify the wiring terminal represented by the point location to match the device point type.

[0053] In some implementations, a module image **715** is displayed on the screen. The module image may be set apart by some method that delineates a specific module. In the illustrative embodiment, a module has a number indication **725** “2,” for this module, but the modules may be sequentially numbered. There also may be a gap **730** between the modules. Other methods that separate modules are also envisioned. All modules may not be filled in a controller. Such unfilled locations may be marked **720**, such as by not having a module number, being in a different color, having different line width, etc.

[0054] In some implementations, the controller comprises modules that plug into the controller. Devices are wired to the modules. The devices are connected to the controller through the module. This is explained in more detail with reference to FIG. **8**. At **800**, a partial system is shown that may be used in embodiments disclosed herein. A controller **805** comprises a processor **810**, memory, **815**, and a display apparatus **820**. The controller may have one or more controller connectors **825**, **830** that connect **835** to module connectors **845**, **850** in the module **840**. The module **840** may have wiring terminals **855**, **860**, that are directly wired **865** through device wires **875**, **880** to a device **870**. This device may be any sort of device, without limitation, that can be wired to a controller. The controller **805** controls the device **870** though the module connectors **845**, **850** communicating to the controller connectors **825**, **830**, and vice-versa.

[0055] This allows the controller to control the equipment, such as turning a heater on, through the controller connector **825**, **830** passing information through the module **840** to the module connectors **845**, **850** on the module **840** to the device wire **875**, **880**, and from the device wire **875**, **880**, to the device **870**. In certain embodiments, a controller may not control a specific resource at all, but infers its state from sensors, the state of other resources, and so forth.

[0056] With reference to FIG. **9**, at **900**, a device type **905**—a three way valve, in this instance—with three device terminal connection types (also called ‘point types’), (–), (O), and (C) from left to right, can be seen being moved to three wiring terminal locations (point locations) **910**. With reference to FIG. **10**, the device **905**, **1005** is moved into the point locations shown at **910**, the device type covering those three locations **1015**, when placed. The controller, knowing the terminal locations of the device type wires, and their device point type (in this case (–), (O), and (C) **1015**) can modify the terminal locations represented by the point locations **910** to match those expected by the device (in this case, a three-way valve **905**, **1005**) that the device type represents.

[0057] With reference to FIG. **11**, a user can select a device point type **1105** on a display apparatus **820**, which may bring up a list of possible device point types available at that controller connector location **825**, **830**. These device point types **1105** may be associated with a wiring terminal **855**, **860** associated with a module **840**, as explained elsewhere. A user can then select the desired device point type from the list. In this case, the device point type is being changed from a (O) to a (+) **1105**.

[0058] With reference to FIG. **12**, and continuing reference to FIG. **11**, a user can change device protocols. Common protocols can be accessed using the interface. In an exemplary implementation, a protocol can be changed by selecting the device protocol text location **1205**. A number of common protocols—allowable protocols—for that device type are revealed **1210**. A user can then

select the desired protocol. The controller **805** will then expect to be connected to a device with the protocol selected. In some instances, this triggers the wiring terminal **855** associated with the chosen slot on the controller to modify itself to match the protocol selected by the user. This change may be triggered by a point type modification request from the controller.

[0059] In some embodiments, this allows the controller, among other things, to determine if the correct device wire has been connected to the correct controller connector **825**, **830**, or the correct module **840** wiring terminal **855**, **860**.

[0060] If the user chooses a new device type that has a different number of device point type wiring locations than the original device type, the display will reflect the new device type, including the number of device point wiring locations that are displayed. The device picture and the wiring terminal point types shown on the display will modify what the controller wiring terminals associated with the display expect. At **1110**, a three-way valve is shown with protocol 24 VAC (3 wire) with three point type locations representing three wiring terminals of types (-), (C), and (O). A user may change the three-way valve protocol to DryContact **1305** by selecting protocol options and then clicking on “drycontact”. This can be seen at **1310**, where the three-way valve shown at **1110** with three terminal connections has now turned into a DryContact three-way valve with two terminal connections **1315**. FIG. **14** illustrates the Three Way Valve of FIG. **13** moved one wiring terminal connection to the left. This leaves the right wiring terminal location **1405** empty.

[0061] With reference to FIGS. **15**, **16**, and **17**, screenshots **1500**, **1600**, and **1700** are disclosed that show an embodiment allowing a device to be selected that has been already placed within the controller representation, and then changed to a different template. In this example, the device selected is a temperature sensor with a 0-10V protocol **1505**. A user selecting the device can display a menu of templates **1605** that can be used with the device **1505**, here “RTD”, “Thermistor”, “0-10V”, and “2-10V”. The current device has the device point types (-) and (+) **1610**. As shown at **1700**, the user selected the template RTD **1705**, which changes the device type template (and thus, the protocol) **410** to RTD **7105** and changes the device point types **425** from (-), (+) **1010** to (+), (-) **1710**.

[0062] With reference to FIGS. **18** and **19**, a controller **1800** is disclosed with a module **1815** that has wiring terminal pins **1210** which can connect a device wire to the controller **1800**. A device wire is placed in the terminal contact wiring pin **1210**. A module **1900** has a set of terminals **1905** that connect the device wire to terminals **1805** on the controller. The modules, in some embodiments, further comprise a module circuit board with memory and software, which can accept a signal from the controller, the signal comprising a designation of a wiring pin **1810** to be modified on the module and a point type modification request (e.g., what type of point type should the pin be?). With this information, the module circuit board has hardware and software that can change the designated wiring pin to the type of modification that has been requested.

[0063] FIG. **20** shows some of the aspects of a module **2000**, with emphasis on the circuit board **2005** and the wiring terminals **2030**, **2050**, **2070**. In some embodiments, the module itself **2000** can make decisions and do processing using hardware and memory **2010** on its circuit board **2005**. The memory may comprise software. A controller **1800**, though a controller terminal **1805** may send messages to a module terminal/module connector **1905**. The module terminal may then send those messages to its circuit board **2005**, which may then process the messages and make decisions. This may result in an altered signal from the signal originally sent by the controller. This altered signal may then be passed to a wire terminal **2030**, **2050**, **2070**, which sends it to a device **2080**. This process may work the opposite way as well. A device **2080** sends a message through a wire terminal **2030** to the circuit board **2005**, which may then process the message, changing the signal. The changed signal is then sent through the module terminal/module connector **2085** to the controller.

[0064] In some embodiments, the controller may send a signal through the module terminal to the wire terminal without making any changes. This may be a point type modification request.

Similarly, in some implementations, a device may send a signal to the controller through the module **2000** without the module making any changes.

[0065] In some embodiments, modules **2000** can do processing and make decisions using the hardware and memory **2010** on their circuit board **2005**. For example, a controller can send a signal **2075** to a module telling it to turn a light off on a device. The module may be able to determine which of its wire terminals **2030**, **2050**, **2070** are associated with the device, and then send the signal **2085** to the device **2080**. In some embodiments the module may be sent information and which specific wire terminal **2030**, **2050**, **2070** the specific information is to be sent to. The same module may be able to handle both situations.

[0066] In an embodiment, a module has three wire terminals, wire terminal A **2030**, wire terminal B **2050**, and wire terminal C **2070**. These wire terminals may be of different functions, eg., type 1, type 2, type 3, type 4, type 5, or type 6. Some terminals may have two or more functions. The circuit board **2005** has hardware associated with the wire terminals that can be enabled, allowing the wire terminals to be of any of those three types. Wire terminal A **2030** has, associated with it in the circuit board, hardware for three types: wire terminal A Type 1 **2015**, wire terminal A Type 2 **2020**, and wire terminal A type 3 **2025**. Wire terminals B, similarly has the hardware potential to be one (or more) of the three types as well-Wire terminal B Type 1 **2035**, wire terminal B Type 2 **2040**, and wire terminal B type 3 **2045**. Wire terminal C has different types associated with it: Wire terminals C Type 4 **2055**, wire terminals C Type 5 **2060**, and wire terminal C type 6 **2065**. The controller can tell the module **2000** through its link with **2075** with module connector **2085** that wire terminal A is supposed to be type 1. The module **2000** may then be able to use its hardware/memory **2010** on its circuit board to send a signal **2090** telling a wire terminal A to be of Type 3. The module **2000** may be able to connect wire terminals A type 3 **2025** to wire terminal A, making wire terminal A of type 3. In some embodiments a single wire terminal may be multiple wire terminal types; for example, wire terminal A could be both type 2 **2020** and type 3 **2025**.

[0067] In an embodiment, images presented on the display are shown to a user in WYSIWYG (what you see is what you get) form. WYSIWYG denotes that the representation on the screen represents, in visual format, the actual controller wiring system.

[0068] In an embodiment, the module is 2.84"×1.91"×1.11" inches. In another embodiment, the module is smaller than 3"×2"×1.25".

[0069] In some implementations, the following modules and module options exist:

Multi Cell Module

[0070] A Multi Cell module may comprise the following options: [0071] A Ground connection (through a FET) [0072] a 24 VAC power connection (through a Triac) [0073] A 0-10V DC analog voltage (via a DAC) [0074] A Strong 1-wire pullup (via a FET) [0075] A High-range voltage divider: It is not known what will be plugged in, so the terminal must anticipate the highest tolerated value (480 volt) if someone plugs in an unknown signal with unknown voltage measure. First, the system checks with high range ability, if it sees a tiny signal, it can switch to low range, then measure the small signal. This way, the module can be safe the whole time. [0076] A Low range voltage divider [0077] A 4-20 mA current shunt [0078] A 24 VAC current shunt [0079] A DC offset injector that can measure both halves of an DC waveform [0080] Real-time current monitoring and real-time voltage monitoring.

Power Cell Module (Also Known as a Lighting Module)

[0081] A power cell module may have some combination of 2× power control blocks, 120/240 VAC output-2 amps, 24 VAC output-2 amps, AC motor control, The power module may also comprise dimmable lighting, real-time current monitoring and real-time voltage monitoring.

Motor Cell Module

[0082] A motor cell module may have some combination of 2× DC motor control blocks, Up to 6 12/24 VDC high current motor drivers, can switch 2050 volt AC up to 10 amps A way to measure voltage

[0083] A chip that measure current—the current that gets consumed passes through, both module connections, detect how much voltage being used and current being used, led's too.

[0084] These modules may also comprise PWM speed control, real-time current monitoring, real-time voltage monitoring, overcurrent/torque protection, and tachometer feedback.

Relay Cell Module

[0085] 2 electromechanical relays

[0086] The relays have 3 connections (normally open, common, normally closed)

[0087] The relay module may be able to measure voltage and current for the common connector on the relays.

[0088] Relay modules may also provide for real-time current monitoring, real-time voltage monitoring, and overcurrent protection.

[0089] Different modules may have different features. The options shown here are illustrative embodiments,

[0090] Reference is made herein to exemplary embodiments such as those illustrated in the drawings, and specific language is used herein to describe the same. But alterations and further modifications of the features illustrated herein, and additional technical applications of the abstract principles illustrated by particular embodiments herein, which would occur to one skilled in the relevant art(s) and having possession of this disclosure, should be considered within the scope of the claims.

Claims

1. A method of configuring a wiring panel for a controller, the method comprising: presenting, on a display, at least two module images, the at least two module images representing at least two modules operably connected to the controller; presenting, within the at least two module images, a plurality of point locations representing respective wiring terminals within a module of the at least two modules; presenting, on the display, a plurality of device types representing respective devices capable of being operably connected to their respective wiring terminals; and responsive to a device type of the plurality of device types being moved onto one of the plurality of point locations, causing the controller to associate a device of the respective devices with the respective wiring terminal.
2. The method of claim 1, wherein the at least two module images indicate that the at least two modules have different types of wiring terminals.
3. The method of claim 2, wherein the at least two module images indicate that the at least two modules have module types, the module types of the at least two modules comprise a motor module type, a relay module type, a power module type, or a multi module type, the module types defining the wiring terminals.
4. The method of claim 3, wherein the at least two module images indicate that the wiring terminals of the motor module type comprise at least one DC motor control block terminal and at least one VDC high current motor driver terminal.
5. The method of claim 3, wherein the at least two module images indicate that the wiring terminals of the relay module type comprise an electromechanical relay, the electromechanical relay having three connections.
6. The method of claim 5, wherein the at least two module images indicate that the three connections of the electromechanical relay comprise a normally open connections, a common connection, and a normally closed connection.
7. The method of claim 3, wherein the at least two module images indicate that the wiring terminals of the power module type comprise at least one power control blocks, at least one 120/240 VAC output, and at least one 24 VAC output.
8. The method of claim 7, wherein the at least two module images indicate that the wiring terminals

of the power module type further comprise at least one AC motor control.

9. A system for controller wiring board configuration, the system comprising: a processor; a memory in operable communication with the processor, software residing in the memory and executable with the processor to perform a method which: presents, on a display, at least two module images, the at least two module images representing at least two modules operably connected to a controller; presents, within the at least two module images, a plurality of point locations, each point location representing a wiring terminal within a module of the at least two modules within the controller; presents a plurality of device types representing respective devices capable of being operable connected to at least one of the wiring terminals; and responsive to a device type of the plurality of device types being moved onto one of the point locations of the plurality of point locations, causing the controller to associate a device with the one of the point locations.

10. The system of claim 9, wherein the device type comprises at least one device point type.

11. The system of claim 10, wherein one of the module of the at least two modules further comprises a module circuit board with memory and software.

12. The system of claim 11, wherein the module uses its module circuit board to modify its wiring terminal associated with the one of the point locations to match the at least one device point type.

13. The system of claim 12, wherein the module of the at least two modules modifies its wiring terminal by activating hardware within the module circuit board.

14. The system of claim 12, wherein the module modifies its wiring terminal using the software of the module circuit board.

15. The system of claim 12, wherein the module further comprises a hardware enabled module function.

16. A non-transitory machine-readable storage medium configured with executable instructions to perform a method for configuring a wiring panel for a controller, the method comprising: presenting, on a display associated with the controller, a module image representing a module operably connected to the controller; presenting, within the module image, a plurality of point locations, each point location representing a wiring terminal within the module of the controller; presenting on the display associated with the controller, a plurality of device types representing devices able to be wired to the wiring terminal through the controller; and responsive to a device type being moved onto at least one point location, causing the controller to associate one of the devices with the at least one point location.

17. The non-transitory machine-readable storage medium of claim 16, wherein the display is a part of the controller.

18. The non-transitory machine-readable storage medium of claim 17, wherein the display and the wiring terminal can be seen simultaneously on the controller.

19. The non-transitory machine-readable storage medium of claim 17, wherein the controller controls the wiring terminal through the module.

20. The non-transitory machine-readable storage medium of claim 18, wherein the controller sends a message to the module, the module then modifying the message and sending it to the wiring terminal.
